

Group 1 Checkpoint 5 – Play Test Observation Notes

During this playtest, our main goal was to evaluate how well the game functions as a complete experience now that most screens and mechanics are implemented. We focused on navigation between screens, overall gameplay flow, mechanic clarity, and difficulty balance, especially during the boss fight. Player feedback was gathered by observing how easily they navigated the game and where issues or frustrations occurred.

Positive comments:

- The start screen was intuitive and easy to understand.
- The player was able to use the mouse to navigate menus without confusion.
- Credits were clear and included proper acknowledgments.
- The player was able to navigate through most of the game successfully.
- All core mechanics were implemented and understandable.
- Mechanics were handled easily by the player, showing good learnability

Observation/Comment from Player	Changes Needed
The player was able to navigate most of the game smoothly, but some mechanics did not work consistently.	Fix and refine mechanics that do not work reliably to ensure finalized gameplay.
The game currently lacks a clear ending.	Add an end screen that displays win/lose state and score, with options to view the scoreboard, play again, or exit the game.
The game felt quiet, and there was no dimensionality.	Add background music, world interaction sound effects, and consider parallax scrolling to make gameplay feel more engaging.
The boss fight was very difficult and felt frustrating. The player took immediate damage even when successfully hitting the boss. Underwhelming and frustrating experience.	Adjust boss mechanics to improve fairness, such as adding a brief damage cooldown or clearer hit feedback.

Takeaways: Overall, the playtest showed that the game is close to being complete and functional for Checkpoint 5. Navigation and mechanics are mostly successful, but refinement is still needed to polish the experience. The biggest areas for improvement: finalizing mechanics, adding audio and sound effects, completing the end screen, rebalancing the boss fight difficulty, and incorporating Parallax scrolling.